



THE LATEST bombing in the U.S.-Iran war began over the weekend. Above, an anti-U.S. billboard in Tehran.

TEHRAN WIDENS ATTACKS IN GULF REGION

As fighting escalates, Iran takes aim at U.S. allies as two sides face increasing pressures.

By David Rising and Samy Magdy

DUBAI — Iran fired on U.S. allies in the Persian Gulf region early Wednesday after a night of American bombardment that Iranian state media say included a deadly strike on a wedding party.

The latest violence came after a monthlong lull in fighting. The six-month war has led to a spike in oil prices, roiled the global economy and posed increasing political problems for President Trump's Republican Party ahead of November midterm elections.

Fighting has escalated since the American military hit Iranian rocket launchers on an island in the Strait of Hormuz over the weekend, saying Iran was planning to use them to lay mines. Iran retaliated by firing missiles at American bases in Jordan that were intercepted.

American military resources are stretched and political pressure in Washington is mounting, and Iran's economy has been battered by sanctions and an American naval blockade. Iran's currency hit another record low Wednesday, with traders in Tehran exchanging 2.20 million rials for one U.S. dollar, a 10% hike from last week's record.

Neither side can continue indefinitely between full-scale war and a truce, said Hamidreza Azizi, senior Iran analyst at the Crisis Group, an international think tank.

"At some point, one of the sides may see a need to escalate in order to break this cycle," he cautioned. "So that could bring the two sides to a point that they have been trying to avoid until now, which is a full-scale war."

The latest flare-up in violence came as the stand-off seemed to be shifting slightly more in the U.S.' favor, with the price of oil hitting around \$80 a barrel last month and Iranian leaders talking about growing economic hardships, said Sascha Bruchmann, an analyst with the International Institute for Strategic Studies' Middle East office in Bahrain.

[See Iran, A4]

NBA hammers Clippers, owner and star after probe

Team loses draft picks, Ballmer and execs get bans over alleged side deals to pay Leonard.

By Steve Henson and Mirjam Swanson

The NBA handed down sweeping penalties to the Clippers, owner Steve Ballmer, team executives and star Kawhi Leonard following an investigation into allegations the group circumvented the league's collective bargaining agreement.

The Clippers said in a statement that they "vehemently reject the NBA's findings" and vowed to challenge them. Leonard issued a statement saying he had

no direct knowledge of the alleged violations.

The findings announced Wednesday, the result of a nearly yearlong investigation conducted by Wachtell Lipton Rosen & Katz, a high-powered New York law firm, determined the Clippers broke NBA rules by initiating off-court income opportunities between Leonard, their seven-time All-NBA forward, and four companies doing business with the team: Aspiration Partners, Boingo Wireless, Daktronics and Lockton Insurance.

The firm's report stated that the Clippers facilitated endorsement agreements between the companies and Leonard, induced the companies to enter into the agreements by offering them business from the

team, paid personal expenses on behalf of Leonard and his representatives and failed to report improper solicitations for off-court income made on Leonard's behalf by Dennis Robertson, his uncle and business manager at the time.

The investigation found Leonard received \$66 million in endorsement pay from four companies facilitated by Ballmer and Clippers executives at the behest of Robertson. Ballmer invested \$60 million in Aspiration, and three other companies received \$22 million from the Clippers in consulting fees.

As a result, the NBA issued the following sanctions:

■ The Clippers are forfeiting five first-round draft

State moves to help fire victims, protect homes

Lawmakers pass bills on house-hardening funds, smoke damage, mandates for insurers.

By Nicole Nixon and Noah Haggerty

SACRAMENTO — California lawmakers passed laws that would ensure financing for upgrades protecting residences from future fire damage and require insurance companies to provide better coverage for smoke-damaged homes.

The measures were among a slew of bills approved during the 2026 legislative session to deal with the continuing aftermath of the devastating 2025 Los Angeles-area fires.

The Eaton and Palisades fires, which destroyed more than 16,000 structures and killed 31, were two of the deadliest and most destructive fires in state history. As with catastrophic fires before them, tragedy spurred action.

Much of the focus on wildfire issues by Gov. Gavin Newsom and California lawmakers in the waning days of the legislative session fo-

cused on a proposal to shift liability away from utilities whose equipment ignites wildfires.

The complex, high-stakes policy debate attempted to address the needs and financial risks faced by the utilities, their customers and insurance companies after the catastrophic wildfires that have plagued California in recent years, but a proposed compromise recently pieced together by lawmakers and the governor fell through Tuesday.

However, lawmakers did pass several bills this year to help fire victims navigate burdensome insurance requirements in the aftermath of a disaster and increase prevention efforts. All head to Newsom for his consideration.

Two complementary bills approved Monday ensure homes that survive a wild-

[See Laws, A11]

State lawmakers kill wildfire bill

Utilities opposed measure to compensate victims sooner, citing financial risks. BUSINESS, A9



WALLY SKALIJ Los Angeles Times

A HOUSE burns in Pacific Palisades last year. Bills on fire safety and recovery await the governor's OK.

REVIEW

As bold and contradictory as L.A.

The Lucas Museum of Narrative Art is synthetic yet organic, populist yet elitist, and right at home

By Sam Lubell



ERIC THAYER Los Angeles Times



ARIANA DREHSLER For The Times



ARIANA DREHSLER For The Times

THE MUSEUM was designed by Ma Yansong, the landscape by Mia Lehrner. Yoda and Grogu statues are outside. Inside: an "Eloise" illustration.

The first thing you notice when approaching the Lucas Museum of Narrative Art from afar is not its curved white shell or the bridge-like body that has long hovered in dreamlike renderings. You see green: a sloping crown of swirling grass rising above Exposition Park. For a moment, it looks as if a hill has appeared in the middle of Los Angeles.

That impression shifts, again and again, as you get closer. The long, glacial structure's facade tightens, bends and twists. Its supports touch down like elephant feet, bolstering what could be a mammoth spacecraft, landing delicately next to the Los Angeles Memorial Coliseum. The building also reveals itself like a body: taut and contorting; bones and joints pressing up against skin. This evolving experience is theatrical enough that you can practically hear the music rising as you approach. But from certain angles, the edifice is just background, hard to register thanks to its sheer improbability; inviting a double take before you again grasp its startling futurism. It is a sneaky monument.

Designed by Beijing-

[See Museum, A6]

Like no other museum on Earth

But the defiant Lucas has a traditional mission, Mary McNamara writes. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

DSA gets into race for L.A. mayor

Winning backing of Democratic Socialists defines Raman against Bass — and nationally.

By Noah Goldberg

The Los Angeles chapter of the Democratic Socialists of America endorsed Councilmember Nithya Raman for mayor Wednesday, giving the challenger a boost of left-wing, door-knocking energy as she challenges incumbent Karen Bass in the Nov. 3 election.

The endorsement came after Raman secured more than 60% of the vote in an online election among the more than 6,000 DSA members in the Los Angeles region, the group said. With nearly 1,500 votes cast, the tally was 937 to endorse Raman and 484 against, with 52 abstentions, according to a screenshot of the vote viewed by The Times.

The DSA is known for espousing controversial positions including defunding the police and abolishing prisons — stances that have drawn scorn from conservatives and put it at odds with the Democratic Party establishment.

The group has notched major electoral victories across the country over the last year, however, most significantly with the election of Zohran Mamdani as mayor of New York.

"The growth of DSA has shown a clear movement to the left nationally," said Sara Sadhwani, a professor of pol-

[See Raman, A7]

Democrats see hope in Texas

Competitive Senate and governor races could scramble presidential map. PERSPECTIVES, A2

A win for state's trans athletes

Judge dismisses U.S. suit, saying athletes can be on teams that match identity. CALIFORNIA, B1

'Wherever he buys, he wins'

Angels players and fans are eager for the chance to rebuild under Stan Kroenke. SPORTS, B9

Weather Sunshine. L.A. Basin: 82/64. B6

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